



CHAPTER ONE



**Preface for the 10th
anniversary edition**



Chapter Summary

In the preface for the 10th anniversary edition of 'The First 90 Days,' Michael D. Watkins reflects on the transformative impact of the past decade. The book, which began as a response to a lack of resources for leadership transitions, has established itself as a seminal work in the field, evolving through practical applications and extensive feedback. Watkins highlights the evolving nature of leadership and transition strategies while acknowledging the enduring success of the book across a global audience. The preface emphasizes the continual relevance of these ideas and the growing recognition of their importance in talent management and onboarding practices. As a classic in business literature, its concepts remain vital for new leaders navigating their roles.



A DECADE OF TRANSFORMATION



Over ten years, 'The First 90 Days' has grown from a unique concept to a cornerstone of leadership transition guidance. The landscape of onboarding and leadership has changed dramatically, underscoring the demand for effective strategies in this critical area.

FROM ACADEMIA TO PRACTICE

Initially met with skepticism, the shift towards focusing on leadership transitions proved to be impactful. The engagement with leaders at Johnson & Johnson was foundational in refining these strategies into practical tools.

A UNIQUE FIELD OF STUDY

When Watkins began his journey in 2001, the subject of onboarding and transitioning was virtually unexplored. Recognizing this gap led to groundbreaking insights that have benefitted countless leaders worldwide.

THE IMPACT OF EARLY WINS

One of the core ideas from the book is the significance of securing early wins. These early accomplishments set the stage for a leader's credibility and paving the way for future successes.



A CONSISTENT BEST-SELLER

Unlike many business books, 'The First 90 Days' sustained its popularity over the years, marking its territory as a trusted resource among leaders and organizations for transitioning effectively.

GLOBAL RECOGNITION

The reach of the book has extended beyond English-speaking audiences, being translated into twenty-seven languages, making its concepts accessible to leaders around the world.

SPAWNING INTEREST IN TALENT MANAGEMENT

The book has catalyzed a broader discussion around talent management and onboarding practices, bringing attention to the need for effective strategies in an increasingly competitive landscape.

"The war for talent became ever more fierce."

ADAPTATION AND GROWTH

Over the years, Watkins has continued to evolve his methodologies, incorporating feedback and findings to enrich the frameworks presented in the book, ensuring they meet contemporary challenges.

"My own thinking has also evolved over the past decade."

SHAPING FUTURE LEADERS



The ongoing success of 'The First 90 Days' not only aids individuals in transition but also contributes to the development of future leaders who are equipped to navigate the complexities of their roles.

THE JOURNEY CONTINUES



With a spirit of gratitude, Watkins acknowledges the collaboration and support he has received throughout his journey, highlighting the importance of community in leadership development.



Recap

- "What a difference a decade makes."
 - "Leadership transitions were too interesting and ripe for study."
 - "It has consistently remained among Harvard Business Review Press's best-sellers."
 - "It has been translated into twenty-seven languages."
 - "The war for talent became ever more fierce."
- 

Thank You

Follow for more insights

